

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Assignment 1: From Unstructured to Structured

Assignment

The following page contains images of twelve social media posts from Instagram. We can think of these as a form of unstructured (or, more accurately, lightly semi-structured) data. Your task in this assignment is as follows:

1. Propose a *rectangular schema* for the data contained in those posts. More specifically, create a **ten-column** tabular data frame with columns representing characteristics / features of the posts. Your schema should describe:
 - (a) What information each column encodes,
 - (b) How that information is encoded, and
 - (c) The rules for encoding that column's information.

The general goal should be to convey as much information / data about the posts as possible.

2. Code and record each of the images according to your schema. In other words, create a small (12-item) rectangular data frame.
3. Choose one of the twelve images that presents an ambiguous case regarding one or more of your features – that is, an image that is difficult to classify / encode. Briefly describe the nature of that ambiguity, and how you resolved it.
4. Write a paragraph about what information / data is *lost* through your encoding scheme. Pick one example of something that is lost, and explain why you decided to exclude it.

Details

Your assignment should include a separate title page with your name, the name of the course, the name of the assignment, and the date on which it was completed / submitted. The body of the written assignment should be double-spaced, in a conventionally-sized (10 to 12 point) font. Your responses to each part of the assignment should be as short or long as you deem necessary. You need not cite any sources for this assignment, or include references, unless you choose to.

This assignment must be completed and submitted by Friday, September 18, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. ET. Submit your assignment by *creating / converting your assignment to PDF format*, and emailing it to Dr. Zorn (at zorn@psu.edu). Assignments received after the due date will not be accepted.

This assignment is worth a possible 100 points.

thedeadcanarypa and goodtimesli...
Phillipsburg, Pennsylvania

YOU'RE INVITED TO
THE DEAD CANARY BREWING COMPANY
GOOD TIMES LINE DANCING
Come enjoy line dancing! No partner needed... just great music, good vibes, line dancing for all levels!

6 1

Liked by thedeadcanarypa and others
goodtimeslinedance Dancing on our favorite hardwood floors September 5th!! Bring your friends and join us for a mixture of line... more

freezethawcycles
Freeze Thaw Cycles

36 1 2

freezethawcycles Ye Olde Freeze + Thaw Wednesday Night Gravel Ride is ON for tonight... more

poorlydrawnlines • 1h

8.4K 24

poorlydrawnlines friend group activated

repsconkin • 23h

INTERNATIONAL HOLOCAUST REMEMBRANCE DAY
JANUARY 27

repsconkin "We must always take sides. Neutrality helps the oppressor, never the victim. Silence encourages the tormentor, never... more

pennstateliberalsarts and psu_liberalartschalkencenter
Penn State

UNDERGRAD RESEARCH EXPO

37 2

pennstateliberalsarts Are you ready to showcase your Liberal Arts research? ... more

brushstrokes_lewisburg • 5h

Annual Mini Art Gallery
\$25 Donation
BENEFITTING:
Lewisburg Scratching Post
and
Haven to Home
IN HOUSE ARTISTS

16 2

brushstrokes_lewisburg Starting now!! 16th Annual Warm Your Heart donation event to benefit @lbgscratchingpost (cats) and... more

spursofficial • 31m

4.8K 42

spursofficial Tonight's stage ...

logisticaggression • 1d

6 2

logisticaggression indoors. #brooklyn #williamsburg #plant #blackandwhite #minimal

shaverscreek and pennstatearbor...
The Arboretum at Penn State

NOW HIRING!
Avian Educator Apprenticeship
Gain hands-on experience in avian research & education through this paid, part-time position. Learn more and apply via the link in bio.

372 3 10 168

Liked by pennstaterptm and others
pennstatearbor... The Arboretum at Penn State and Shaver's Creek Environmental Center are hiring an Avian Educator... more

crpr_sc • 5d

3 2

crpr_sc Play Ball! Our first session of Start Smart Winter Baseball was a home run as little sluggers and their parents learned... more

catsbeingweirdlittleguys • 1w

Jonathan Edward Durham
@thisone0verhere
Having a full conversation with a really yappy cat is one of life's most distinct pleasures

28.4K 37

catsbeingweirdlittleguys tummy ache: \$1200 ... more

sarcasm_only • 1d
Original audio

Me calling my bestie to see what we going to do for Valentine's Day since she's the only stable relationship I have

36.1K 352

sarcasm_only Hey bestie ...